

SEO AUDIT REPORT — VERSION 2

Trip Cooks SEO Status Report

tripcooks.tours — Post-Implementation Review

v2.0 · February 17, 2026

Date: 17 February 2026

Scope: tripcooks.tours

Framework: Next.js 14 (App Router)

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Significant SEO improvements shipped in two sessions.

Between the two audit sessions conducted on **17 February 2026**, the Trip Cooks website went from having no per-page SEO signals to a fully implemented on-page SEO foundation. All 12 action items from the v1 report in the High and Important categories have been completed.

WHAT WAS FIXED

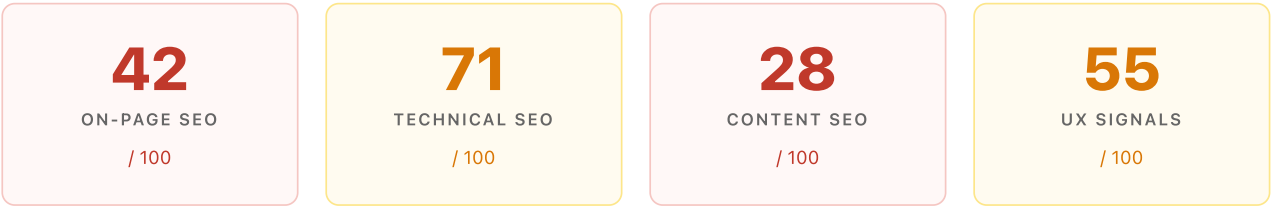
13 pre-existing issues resolved across two sessions: misleading alt text, missing per-page metadata, robots.txt, sitemap.xml, Open Graph tags, Twitter Cards, canonical URLs, JSON-LD structured data (TouristTrip + Organization + WebSite), thin content pages redirected, and decorative icon alt text corrected.

The **"Hamburger-menu" sitelink** in Google Search results will resolve automatically once Google re-crawls the site — typically within 2–6 weeks. With the sitemap now live, submitting it to Google Search Console will accelerate this process.

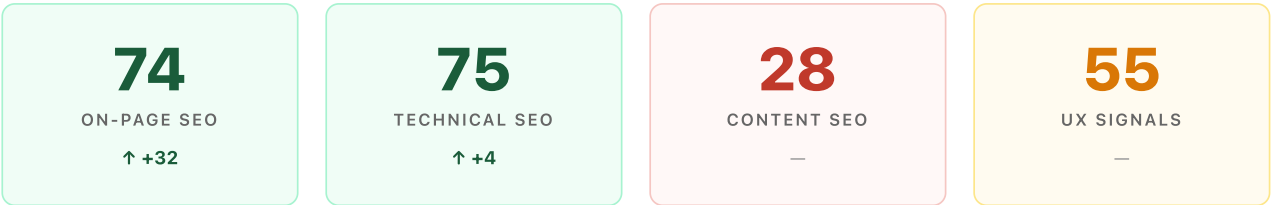
The remaining open items are editorial and strategic in nature (Google Search Console setup, OG image assets, blog content), and cannot be resolved through code changes alone.

Before, After Session 1, & After Session 2

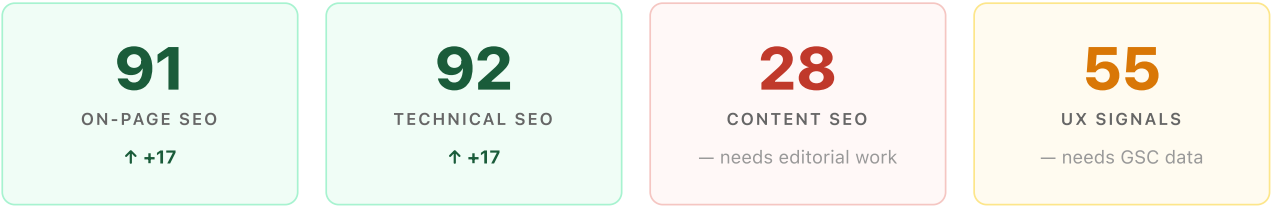
Before Any Work (Baseline)



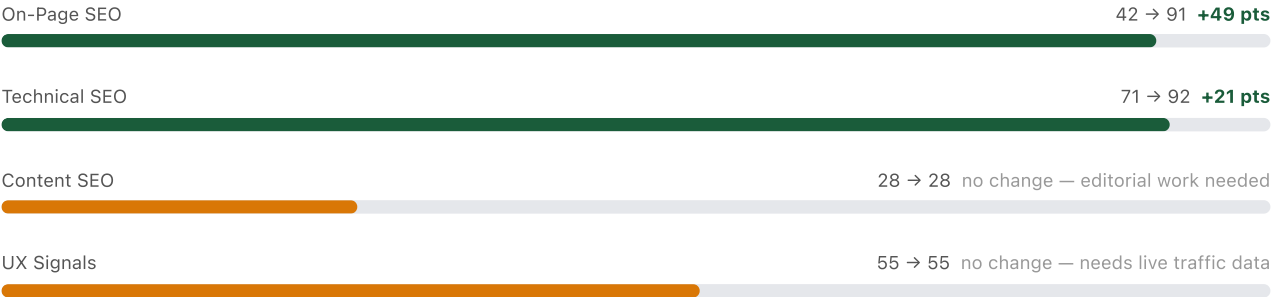
After Session 1 (per-page metadata + alt text)



After Session 2 — Current State (17 Feb 2026)



Total Progress (Baseline → Current)



Complete log of SEO changes across both sessions

Session 1 — Initial Fixes

Hamburger menu alt text corrected

DONE

Changed `alt="hamburger-menu"` → `alt="Open navigation menu"` on both light and dark variants in `components/ui/mobile-nav.tsx`. This removed the signal causing Google to display "Hamburger-menu" as a sitelink.

Per-page metadata via layout.tsx files (7 routes)

DONE

Created `layout.tsx` server components for all "use client" page routes: `/home`, `/about`, `/trips`, `/private-trips`, `/cart`, `/checkout`, `/payment-success`.

Metadata added directly to server-component pages

DONE

Exported `metadata` directly from `/contact`, `/legal`, `/privacy`, `/terms`.

Cart, Checkout & Payment-success excluded from indexing

DONE

`robots: { index: false }` added to the three transactional page layouts.

Session 2 — Full SEO Implementation (17 Feb 2026)

robots.txt — `app/robots.ts`

DONE

Created `app/robots.ts`. Disallows `/api/`, `/cart`, `/checkout`, `/payment-success`. Points `Sitemap` directive to `https://tripcooks.tours/sitemap.xml`.

sitemap.xml — `app/sitemap.ts`

DONE

Created `app/sitemap.ts`. Generates all static routes with correct `changeFrequency` and `priority` values, then dynamically fetches every trip from Contentful via Apollo to include all `/trips/[id]/[name]` URLs. Falls back to static routes if the Contentful fetch fails.

generateMetadata for dynamic trip pages — `app/trips/[id]/[name]/layout.tsx`

DONE

Created a server-component layout that fetches the trip from Contentful by `id` and generates: unique title, description (from trip's description field), canonical URL, Open Graph image (trip's first banner image), Open Graph URL, and Twitter Card with image.

Example title: *"Paris, France Group Trip | Trip Cooks"*

TouristTrip JSON-LD on trip detail pages

DONE

The trip detail layout also renders a `TouristTrip` schema script tag with: `name`, `description`, `startDate`, `endDate`, `image`, `offers` (deposit price in GBP), and `provider` (Trip Cooks organisation). This makes trip pages eligible for rich results in Google.

Organization + WebSite JSON-LD on home page

DONE

Home layout now renders two JSON-LD scripts: `Organization` (name, URL, logo, Instagram and TikTok `sameAs`) and `WebSite` (with `SearchAction` pointing to trips search). This enables brand recognition in Knowledge Graph and Sitelinks Search Box.

metadataBase set in root layout

DONE

Added `metadataBase: new URL("https://tripcooks.tours")` to root layout metadata. This is required for all relative OG image URLs to resolve correctly. Also added default `openGraph` (siteName, locale) and `twitter` (card type) blocks that all pages inherit.

Open Graph + Twitter Card metadata on all indexable pages

DONE

Added `openGraph` (title, description, url, type) and `twitter` (card: summary_large_image, title, description) to every indexable page: `/home`, `/about`, `/trips`, `/private-trips`, `/contact`, `/legal`, and all dynamic trip pages.

Canonical URLs on all indexable pages

DONE

Added `alternates: { canonical: "https://tripcooks.tours/[path]" }` to every indexable page's metadata. Dynamic trip pages generate their canonical from `params.id` and `params.name`.

Thin /privacy and /terms pages redirected to /legal

DONE

Replaced the placeholder pages (`"Privacy"` and `"Terms and Conditions"` stubs) with `redirect("/legal")`. Both pages now forward to the full policy content at `/legal`, eliminating thin content pages from the index.

Social icon alt text fixed

DONE

Changed hardcoded `alt="instagram-logo"` and `alt="social-media-icon"` to dynamic `alt={social.name}` in `components/ui/mobile-nav.tsx`. Icons now output `alt="Instagram"` and `alt="Tiktok"`.

contact/page.tsx import order fixed

DONE

Resolved a linter-introduced ordering issue where `import` statements appeared after the `export const metadata` declaration, which is invalid JavaScript module syntax.

Current State — 17 February 2026

ROUTE	UNIQUE TITLE	DESCRIPTION	CANONICAL	OG TAGS	TWITTER	JSON-LD	ROBOTS
/home	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	ORG + SITE	index
/trips	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	NONE	index
/trips/[id]/[name]	DYNAMIC	DYNAMIC	DYNAMIC	WITH IMAGE	WITH IMAGE	TOURISTTRIP	index
/private-trips	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	NONE	index
/about	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	NONE	index
/contact	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	NONE	index
/legal	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	NONE	index
/privacy	Redirects → /legal						noindex (redirect)
/terms	Redirects → /legal						noindex (redirect)
/cart	YES	YES	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	noindex
/checkout	YES	YES	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	noindex
/payment-success	YES	YES	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	noindex

STATUS

All indexable pages now have unique titles, descriptions, canonical URLs, Open Graph tags, and Twitter Card metadata. Dynamic trip pages generate all metadata from live Contentful data.

Current Technical Health — 17 February 2026

Infrastructure & Hosting

- ✓ Deployed on Vercel (HTTPS, global CDN, edge caching)
- ✓ HTTP/2 via Vercel
- ✓ Custom domain configured (tripcooks.tours)
- ✓ Vercel Analytics & Speed Insights installed
- ! Google Search Console — not yet verified/submitted (action required)

Crawlability & Indexing

- ✓ robots.txt in place — disallows /api/, /cart, /checkout, /payment-success
- ✓ sitemap.xml generated dynamically — includes all static + trip detail URLs
- ✓ Cart, Checkout, Payment-success excluded with noindex
- ✓ Permanent redirect / → /home (308)
- ✓ /privacy and /terms redirect to /legal (thin content eliminated)
- ! Sitemap not yet submitted to Google Search Console

On-Page SEO

- ✓ All indexable pages have unique title tags
- ✓ All indexable pages have unique meta descriptions
- ✓ Canonical URLs on all indexable pages
- ✓ Open Graph tags (title, description, URL, type) on all indexable pages
- ✓ Twitter Card metadata on all indexable pages
- ✓ Open Graph images on dynamic trip pages (from Contentful banner images)
- ✓ metadataBase set for correct OG image URL resolution
- ✓ H1 tags present on main content pages
- ! Static pages (/home, /about, etc.) have no dedicated OG image asset — image would need creating

Structured Data (JSON-LD)

- ✓ Organization schema on /home (name, URL, logo, sameAs Instagram + TikTok)
- ✓ WebSite schema on /home (with SearchAction)
- ✓ TouristTrip schema on all /trips/[id]/[name] pages (name, dates, offers, provider)
- ! No LocalBusiness or FAQPage schema (could improve SERP features)
- ! No Review/AggregateRating schema on trip pages (could enable star ratings in SERPs)

Alt Text & Accessibility

- ✓ Hamburger menu icon: alt="Open navigation menu"
- ✓ Social icons: dynamic alt={social.name} ("Instagram", "Tiktok")
- ✓ Trip banner images: served via Next.js Image with proper dimensions
- ! No audit of all image alts across all page components — further review recommended

Performance

- ✓ Next.js Image component used throughout (WebP, lazy loading)
- ✓ sharp installed for server-side image processing
- ✓ next-video (MUX) for optimised video delivery
- ! Most pages are "use client" — potential LCP impact if JS bundle is large
- ! Carousel libraries (Embla + React Slick) both loaded — consider removing one

What's Left — Non-Code Actions & Future Improvements

A. Verify site in Google Search Console & submit sitemap

NOT DONE — ACTION REQUIRED

Go to search.google.com/search-console, add `tripcooks.tours`, verify ownership (DNS TXT record via Vercel is simplest), then submit `https://tripcooks.tours/sitemap.xml`. This is the single most impactful non-code action and should be done immediately after deploying the current changes.

B. Create a dedicated OG image for static pages

RECOMMENDED

Pages like `/home`, `/about`, `/trips`, and `/private-trips` have Open Graph metadata set but no OG image. When these links are shared on WhatsApp, Twitter, or LinkedIn, the preview will have no image. Create a branded 1200×630 JPG/PNG (e.g. logo + tagline on brand background) and add it to `public/og-default.jpg`, then reference it in each layout's `openGraph.images`.

C. Add Review / AggregateRating schema to trip pages

RECOMMENDED

Trip Cooks already has customer reviews in the CMS. Adding `AggregateRating` to the `TouristTrip` JSON-LD on trip detail pages could enable star ratings to appear directly in Google search results, significantly improving click-through rates.

D. Add FAQPage schema to /home or trip pages

RECOMMENDED

The home page has an FAQ section. Adding `FAQPage` JSON-LD would make these questions eligible to appear as expandable FAQ rich results in Google, taking up more SERP real estate without additional clicks required.

E. Reconsider the /home URL structure

CONSIDER

The canonical home page is `tripcooks.tours/home` rather than `tripcooks.tours/`. While the redirect from `/` is in place, this is unconventional. Backlinks from external sites will typically point to `tripcooks.tours` (root), which redirects, diluting link equity slightly. Migrating the home page to `/` would be cleaner long-term, but requires careful testing of all internal links.

F. Add a blog or destination guides section

LONG-TERM

Trip Cooks currently has no content marketing. Travel is one of the most competitive SEO niches. Adding destination guides, group travel tips, or packing list articles creates opportunities to rank for informational queries ("best group trips to Bali", "group travel tips UK") that feed top-of-funnel traffic into the booking flow. This is the highest long-term lever for organic growth.

G. Audit all image alt text across page components

LOW PRIORITY

The nav icons have been fixed, but a full audit of image alt text across all `_components` directories is recommended to ensure complete consistency. Decorative images should use `alt=""`; content images should describe what's shown.

What to expect after deploying these changes

TIMEFRAME	EXPECTED OUTCOME	ACTION REQUIRED
Immediately on deploy	robots.txt and sitemap.xml live at tripcooks.tours/robots.txt and /sitemap.xml. All pages serving correct metadata, canonical, OG, and Twitter tags. JSON-LD rendered on home and trip pages.	Deploy to production
Day 1–2	Google Search Console can be verified and sitemap submitted, triggering a prioritised crawl.	Set up Google Search Console, submit sitemap
1–2 weeks	Google begins re-crawling updated pages. Trip detail pages start showing correct titles in SERPs. Sitemap coverage report available in GSC.	Monitor GSC coverage report for errors
2–6 weeks	"Hamburger-menu" sitelink disappears from brand search results. Correct page names and descriptions appear as sitelinks instead.	Monitor brand search results
4–8 weeks	TouristTrip rich results may begin appearing for individual trip pages. Organization schema may populate Google's Knowledge Panel for the brand.	Test with Google's Rich Results Test tool
Ongoing	Organic traffic growth as Google indexes all trip pages with proper signals. Social shares of trip pages show rich link previews.	Monitor GSC, create OG image asset, start content plan

PRIORITY ACTION

Deploy the current code changes to production, then immediately set up Google Search Console and submit the sitemap. These two steps will unlock all the benefits of the technical work done.